

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

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Last week: DJIA 44175.61 ▲ 587.03 1.35% NASDAQ 21450.02 ▲ 3.9% STOXX 600 547.08 ▲ 2.1% 10-YR. TREASURY (New Issue) yield 4.282% OIL \$63.88 ▼ \$3.45 EURO \$1.1643 YEN 147.73

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Nvidia and ADM** agreed to give the Trump administration a portion of the sales from their artificial-intelligence chips to China, unusual agreements that deepen their relationships with the U.S. government. **A1**

◆ **U.S. companies** are repurchasing their shares at a record pace, with \$983.6 billion of buybacks announced so far this year. The trend is boosting balance sheets and fueling the stock rally. **A1**

◆ **Intel CEO Lip-Bu Tan** is set to visit the White House after Trump called for his removal last week over ties to Chinese businesses. **A3**

◆ **As valuations** of Nvidia, OpenAI and other artificial-intelligence companies soar, so do investments in hedge funds that are hoping to ride the AI wave. **B1**

◆ **A companywide survey** at Target shows large numbers of employees lack confidence in the company's future, reflecting challenges as the chain tries to revive growth. **B1**

◆ **Warby Parker's** strategy of holding to the \$95 price of its most affordable glasses faces a severe test as Trump's tariffs are likely to raise its costs. **B1**

◆ **Efforts by Alaska Air** and Delta to expand overseas flights from Seattle have reignited a rivalry over the city both carriers consider a hub. **B1**

◆ **JPMorgan's Dimon** has taken his annual bus tour through new territory in the South as he seeks to expand the bank's reach. **B1**

World-Wide

◆ **European powers** and Ukraine responded to Putin's cease-fire plan with a counterproposal they say must serve as a framework so that coming talks between Trump and the Russian leader can gain traction. **A1**

◆ **Netanyahu said** Israel's new war plan includes dismantling Hamas in Gaza's central refugee camps in addition to Gaza City, a broadening that comes as he faces mounting criticism abroad and at home. **A6**

◆ **Chinese authorities** have held for questioning Liu Jia-chao, a diplomat widely seen as a potential foreign minister for the regime. **A7**

◆ **Trump's deals with U.S.** trading partners highlight an aggressive strategy in which his aides have used pressure and threats of high tariffs to quickly make agreements. **A4**

◆ **Worker-relocation** programs that began as an experiment during the pandemic to lure people back to small towns are becoming a widespread strategy. **A3**

◆ **Decades of close ties** between India and Russia pose a challenge for Trump in persuading Modi to stop massive purchases of oil from Moscow. **A6**

◆ **Families of 9/11 victims** suing Saudi Arabia are hoping Cantor Fitzgerald ex-CEO Lutnick, now commerce secretary, will aid their cause. **A3**

◆ **Munitions in an arms** depot linked to Hezbollah exploded as Lebanese army experts were dismantling them, killing six. **A7**

JOURNAL REPORT

Investing Monthly: What to know about selling gold. **B6-7**

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MLB's First Female Umpire Is Right at Home



COLIN HUBBARD/ASSOCIATED PRESS

STRIKING DEBUT: Jen Pawol called pitches in her first game behind the plate in Atlanta on Sunday, as the Braves beat the Miami Marlins 7-1, a day after she worked at first and third bases in a doubleheader. She donated her hat to the Hall of Fame. **A2**

Ukraine and Europe Counter Russia's Cease-Fire Proposal

New plan responds to Kremlin territorial demands, prior to Trump-Putin talks

By BOJAN PANCEVSKI
AND YAROSLAV TROFIMOV

BERLIN—European powers and Ukraine responded to Vladimir Putin's cease-fire plan with a counterproposal they say must serve as a framework so that coming talks between President Trump and the Russian

leader can gain traction, European officials familiar with the talks said.

The European plan rejected a Russian proposal to trade Ukrainian-held parts of the Donetsk region for a cease-fire. It was put forward in a meeting with top U.S. officials in England on Saturday.

Russia hasn't made steps toward peace despite its talks with the U.S., Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky said on Sunday, calling for U.S. sanctions against Russia's economy. Russia launched an aerial attack on

Sunday on Ukraine's southeastern city of Zaporizhzhia, where at least 19 people were injured after homes, a clinic and a bus stop were hit, according to emergency services.

"Sanctions are needed, pressure is needed," he said. "If Russia does not want to stop the war, then its economy must be stopped."

A U.S. official said the Saturday meetings made progress toward Trump's goal of ending the war in Ukraine. A European participant said the U.S. side reacted positively to the Euro-

pean plan.

European leaders, including France's President Emmanuel Macron, German Chancellor Friedrich Merz and U.K. Prime Minister Keir Starmer, said in a joint statement after the meeting that a diplomatic end to the war must protect Ukraine's and Europe's security interests.

"We are convinced that only an approach that combines active diplomacy, support to Ukraine and pressure on the Russian Federation to end their illegal war can succeed," the

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Tragedy Thwarts Dissident's Rescue

Alexei Navalny's death in prison came before his expected release in a prisoner swap

By JOE PARKINSON AND DREW HINSHAW

Roger Carstens was rushing across Tel Aviv to meet Roman Abramovich, knowing he would have to ask the White House for forgiveness rather than permission.

Twice before, the Biden administration had turned down requests by the

special presidential envoy for hostage affairs to meet this enigmatic Russian oligarch, one of the handful of people Carstens considered a "back channel wizard" with the influence to untangle the thorniest diplomatic knots.

But in November 2023, when Carstens traveled to Israel to help American families whose loved ones

Hamas had taken hostage, a message reached his phone saying Abramovich was also in town. It seemed like an unmissable chance to advance a prisoner swap that could free U.S. citizens jailed in Russia—and at the same time, rescue Vladimir Putin's archnemesis, the Russian dissident leader Alexei Navalny.

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Job Search Crosses \$10,000 Threshold

By LINDSAY ELLIS

It takes a lot of money to make money, especially when it comes to looking for a job these days.

Josh Morgan, 45 years old, was laid off from his senior finance role late last year. After several fruitless months of searching for a new one, he paid a company about \$10,000 for six months' help.

The firm provides weekly meetings with a career strategist to evaluate open roles and sources potential jobs from talent recruiters. It also created a personal website for Morgan and lets him use software that helps tailor his résumé to job descriptions.

"They're like a marketing company, and I'm the product," said Morgan, who lives in Greensboro, N.C. He is still looking for work, but says the price will be worth it if it helps

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◆ **Some cities pay people to move there..... A3**

INSIDE



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PERSONAL JOURNAL
The rambunctious Krypto in 'Superman' divides summer moviegoers. **A10**



BUSINESS & FINANCE
JPMorgan Chase's Jamie Dimon explores the South on his annual bus tour. **B1**

America's Great Pickle Divide Leaves Many Feeling Sour

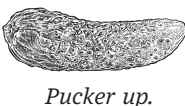
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Pickle craze escalates tensions between people who love them and those who don't

By NATALIE WEGER

All day long, Bryce Austin caters to pickle lovers. They flood the New York City store where he works to forage for pickles and pickled products. It's nauseating.

Austin, 20, has hated pickles for as long as he can remember. He wears a designated pair of pants to work at the Pickle Guys so he doesn't contaminate the rest of his wardrobe with the smell that follows him home. He



Pucker up.

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Record Buybacks Led by Banks, Tech Fuel Rally in Stocks

By KRYSTAL HUR

American companies are repurchasing their shares at a record pace, boosting their balance sheets and fueling the U.S. stock rally.

U.S. companies have announced \$983.6 billion of stock buybacks this year, the best start to a year on record, according to Birinyi Associates data going back to 1982. They are projected to purchase more than \$1.1 trillion overall in 2025, which would mark a high.

The biggest repurchasers include tech giants Apple and Google parent Alphabet. Big banks such as JPMorgan Chase, Bank of America and Morgan Stanley also are leading the charge.

Strong earnings growth and tax cuts have helped fill corporate coffers, while powering stocks out of their tariff-driven April rout and lifting the S&P 500 and Nasdaq composite to records. At the same time, the confusion around trade has stalled many businesses' in-

Trump Secures A Cut of Chip Sales To China

Nvidia, AMD to give the government 15% in unusual deal for export licenses

By AMRITH RAMKUMAR
AND ROBBIE WHELAN

Nvidia and Advanced Micro Devices have agreed to give the Trump administration a portion of the sales from their artificial-intelligence chips to China, unusual agreements that deepen their relationships with the U.S. government.

The Trump administration will receive 15% of the sales as part of a deal to approve exports of Nvidia's H20 AI chip to China, according to people familiar with the matter. That could amount to billions of dollars given demand for the H20 chips and is the latest example of the White House employing unusual tactics to raise revenue.

The administration has reached the same agreement with AMD for its MI308 chip, the people said. Details of the arrangements and the financial structures were still being worked out.

The Commerce Department began issuing licenses for Nvidia to send its H20 chip to China Friday, following through on a July promise. Over the weekend, the agency started moving licenses for the AMD chip, some of the people familiar with the matter said.

Exports of both the H20 and MI308 were halted in April, when trade tensions between the U.S. and China were simmering. Huang has gone on a charm offensive since then, talking to officials in both countries about the need to do business with one another.

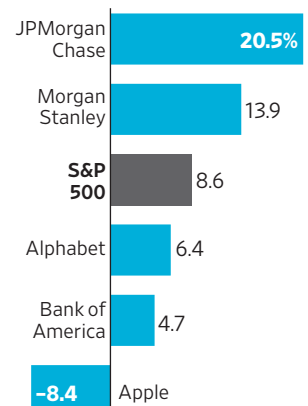
"We follow rules the U.S. government sets for our participation in worldwide markets," Nvidia said in a statement Sunday. "While we haven't shipped H20 to China for months, we hope export control rules will let America compete in China and worldwide."

The revenue agreement came after Huang met with President Trump Wednesday, the same day Trump announced tech companies that invest in the U.S. would be exempt from new chip tariffs. The Financial Times earlier reported on the agreements.

It is unusual for companies

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Share-price and index performance, year to date



Source: FactSet

vestment plans, making buybacks a more appealing use of incoming cash.

"Things are better than everyone makes them seem," said Jeffrey Yale Rubin, president of Birinyi Associates. "Companies are flush with cash. They were in healthy shape even before the better earnings."

Both companies and investors

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